

JShotz Quick Guide

Version 3.13.13

JShotz records your browsing as a series of screenshots and turns them into a PDF — handy for documenting a process, a support case, or a step-by-step walkthrough.

Getting started

- Load JShotz as a browser extension, then click the JShotz icon in your toolbar. Do not open

`popup.html` directly from its folder; it needs the browser extension runtime to record.

- Choose a **Capture source**:

- **Tab viewport only** — screenshots of the page you're on.

- **API + Screenshot** — same, plus a table of the page's network calls under each shot. JShotz observes page network calls only while this source is selected.

- **Screen / window** — share your whole screen, a window, or a tab (the only option that can show DevTools or other apps).

- Click **Start recording**.
- Use the page normally — screenshots are taken automatically as you click and scroll.
- To take a break without ending the session, click **Pause recording**. It becomes

Continue recording; continuing keeps the same screenshots, numbering, and session folder.

- Clear unwanted frames in the **Screenshots** list, then click **Stop recording**, choose

Yes, keep, and pick a PDF name. The PDF includes only the screenshots still checked; your original PNGs are kept in the session folder.

You can change the capture source at any time without stopping the recording.

If Chrome restarts during an active recording, return to the restored page and open the JShotz popup. The recording reconnects to that live tab and preserves the existing screenshots, numbering, and session folder.

If a browser or extension crash leaves only an earlier screenshot folder, use ****Resume capture from folder****. JShotz loads that folder's screenshots, starts at the next number, and includes the old and new screenshots in its checkpoint and final PDFs.

If Chrome no longer grants write access to that selected folder, recording still continues and new screenshots go to the normal Downloads session folder. Use **Reconnect capture folder** when you want later screenshots and the final PDF to write directly to the original folder again.

If Chrome says JShotz needs access after a redirect, open the JShotz popup on the current page and

continue recording. For flows that move between websites, set JShotz **Site access** to ****On all sites**** in Chrome's extension details.

Updating the extension

Unzip the new JShotz package, load the folder containing `manifest.json` from `chrome://extensions` or `edge://extensions`, and make sure only one JShotz copy is enabled. Then close and reopen any browser tab that was already open during the update before recording. Chrome may retain an **Extension context invalidated** error for an old page script; delete that error card after reopening the tab.

Capturing a screenshot manually

To do this	Do this
Capture right now	Click Capture now in the popup
Capture with the keyboard	Press Ctrl+Alt+Q
Capture a DevTools panel	Open the panel, press Alt+Shift+S
Capture in 5 seconds (time to click into DevTools)	Click Capture in 5s , or press Alt+Shift+D

Getting the whole page in one shot

Turn on **"Whole-page shot for Ctrl+Alt+Q and Capture now"** in settings, then use one of those two actions (or Capture in 5s) to capture the *entire* page — including everything below the fold — without enlarging or reflowing the page. Everyday automatic captures (clicks, scrolling) are left as normal single-screen shots so your view is never disturbed. Very long pages are saved as adjacent, numbered parts instead of one oversized image; the parts remain in order when you export the PDF. A progress bar appears in the popup and on the page while the whole-page capture is running, then disappears when it finishes. For ordinary documents, Chrome may show a "started debugging this browser" banner for a moment. That browser notice clears on its own; JShotz does not resize the page to take the capture.

Saving a PDF partway through

Click **Export PDF so far** at any point to save everything captured up to that moment as a PDF,

without stopping the recording. Keep going afterward — your final PDF at "Stop recording" uses the screenshots selected at that time.

Choose PDF screenshots

Every captured screenshot starts selected for PDF output. Before a checkpoint or final export:

- Clear the checkbox beside any screenshot you do not want in the PDF.
- Use **Select all** to include every screenshot again.
- Use **Show older screenshots** when the recording has more than 50 captures.

Your selection remains with the active recording when the popup closes. Only selected screenshots appear in **Export PDF so far** and the PDF created when you stop the recording.

Resume an interrupted capture

- Open the page where you want to continue the flow.
- Click **Resume capture from folder** in the popup.
- Choose the earlier session's screenshot folder in the native folder dialog and allow read/write

access.

- JShotz refreshes the **Screenshots** list with the earlier files and immediately captures the

current page as the next screenshot.

New PNG files, checkpoint PDFs, the final PDF, and the refreshed `flow-manifest.json` are written to that same selected folder. No browser tab is opened for this action. It is available in Chrome and Edge; Firefox can record normally but cannot write directly into an arbitrary existing folder. If Chrome or Edge asks for folder access again after a restart, the button becomes ****Reconnect capture folder****. Choose the same folder to continue without resetting the current flow.

Shortcuts and common fixes

- `Ctrl+Alt+Q` : capture manually while the page has focus.
- `Alt+Shift+S` : capture the currently visible DevTools panel.
- `Alt+Shift+D` : start a five-second countdown, then capture. Use this when you need time to

click into DevTools.

You can change extension shortcuts at `chrome://extensions/shortcuts` or the Firefox equivalent.

If a page was open while JShotz was installed, reloaded, or updated, refresh that page before recording. Browser internal pages and the extension store cannot be recorded because browsers

protect them from extensions.

Every screenshot in the **Screenshots** list starts checked. Clear the checkbox beside any frame you do not want in the PDF. **Select all** is checked while every frame is included and clears when any individual frame is removed. The choice remains for the current recording if the popup closes and is reopened.

After resuming a folder, the same selection list contains the earlier and newly captured screenshots.

Only checked screenshots are included in the checkpoint and final PDFs.

Where do my files go?

Everything is saved under your Downloads folder:

```
Downloads/flow-captures/session_<date-time>/
```

This includes your screenshots, the PDF, and a technical `debugLog` inside

`flow-manifest.json` for troubleshooting. The log is stored in the extension background while you record, so it never interrupts a recording with a separate download prompt.

When you resume from a folder, JShotz writes new files directly beside the earlier screenshots in the folder you selected instead of creating a new Downloads session folder.

Multiple tabs

If the page you're recording opens a new tab (like a sign-in redirect), JShotz follows it automatically. Switching back and forth between tabs keeps capturing wherever you are. Pausing does not remove those tracked tabs or child windows, so continuing follows the same browser flow.

Need help?

If something doesn't look right, note roughly when it happened and what you were doing, and share that along with the screenshot in question.